

ANONYMIZED CASE STUDY

Historical Source Verification

Independent review of a historical argument, source base and evidentiary limits

METHOD

Claim testing | Source verification | Overreach control

MIKE CHARLIE RESEARCH

PORTFOLIO SAMPLE

Historical Source Verification

Independent review of a historical argument, source base and evidentiary limits

CLAIM TESTING | SOURCE VERIFICATION | OVERREACH CONTROL

MIKE CHARLIE RESEARCH

Archival, historical and evidence-based research

Portfolio sample prepared from a completed research assignment. All identifying details have been removed.

Executive Summary

A client required an independent assessment of a historical argument intended for publication. The assignment focused on whether the central claims were supported by the cited evidence, whether the terminology was historically defensible, and where the text moved beyond what the sources could establish.

ASSIGNMENT	Independent review of a historical research memorandum
RESEARCH TYPE	Historical source verification and evidentiary analysis
PRIMARY OUTPUT	Structured findings, claim-level assessment and revision recommendations
CONFIDENTIALITY	Client, publication, project title and source identifiers removed

Client Challenge

The client needed more than proofreading. The text required a defensible distinction between documented fact, reasonable interpretation and unsupported extension. Several claims depended on secondary literature, broad historical context or terminology whose meaning changed across jurisdictions and periods.

Methodology

- Mapped the principal claims and the evidence cited for each.
- Separated direct evidence, contextual support and inference.

- Checked terminology against relevant historical and scholarly usage.
- Reviewed the source base for gaps, asymmetry and overreliance.
- Marked conclusions as supported, supportable with revision, or not demonstrated.

Research Process

01	Claim inventory Converted the draft into a working list of verifiable propositions and dependent assumptions.
02	Evidence review Compared the wording of each proposition with the actual scope of the available evidence.
03	Source criticism Assessed provenance, relevance, chronology, jurisdiction and the difference between primary and secondary support.
04	Overreach control Identified passages where a plausible interpretation had been presented as an established fact.
05	Revision guidance Recommended narrower wording, additional sourcing or removal where the evidentiary threshold was not met.

Outcome

The review produced a structured, claim-level assessment that distinguished defensible conclusions from passages requiring qualification. The client received a clearer basis for revising the historical argument without presenting interpretation as proof. The assignment also documented negative findings and unresolved evidentiary gaps.

SUPPORTED Claims adequately grounded in the available evidence	REVISE Claims that could be retained with narrower wording	UNRESOLVED Questions not answerable from the reviewed source base
--	--	---

Skills Demonstrated

Historical Research | Source Verification | Archival Research | Fact-Checking | Research Writing